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COVER STORY

Kimwolf Botnet Swamps Anonymity Network I2P

I2P users started reporting disruptions in the network around the same time the Kimwolf botmasters began relying on it to evade takedown attempts against the botnet's control servers.

Brian Krebs · Krebs on Security

For the past week, the massive “Internet of Things” (IoT) botnet known as Kimwolf has been disrupting The Invisible Internet Project (I2P), a decentralized, encrypted communications network designed to anonymize and secure online communications. I2P users started reporting disruptions in the network around the same time the Kimwolf botmasters began relying on it to evade takedown attempts against the botnet’s control servers.

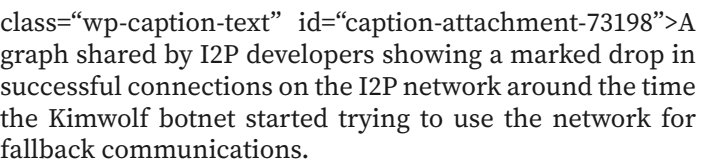
Kimwolf is a botnet that surfaced in late 2025 and quickly infected millions of systems, turning poorly secured IoT devices like TV streaming boxes, digital picture frames and routers into relays for malicious traffic and abnormally large distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) attacks.

I2P is a decentralized, privacy-focused network that allows people to communicate and share information anonymously.

“It works by routing data through multiple encrypted layers across volunteer-operated nodes, hiding both the sender’s and receiver’s locations,” the I2P website explains. “The result is a secure, censorship-resistant network designed for private websites, messaging, and data sharing.”

On February 3, I2P users began complaining on the organization’s GitHub page about tens of thousands of routers suddenly overwhelming the network, preventing existing users from communicating with legitimate nodes. Users reported a rapidly increasing number of new routers joining the network that were unable to transmit data, and that the mass influx of new systems had overwhelmed the network to the point where users could no longer connect.

When one I2P user asked whether the network was under attack, another user replied, “Looks like it. My physical router freezes when the number of connections exceeds 60,000.”

A graph shared by I2P developers showing a marked drop in successful connections on the I2P network around the time the Kimwolf botnet started trying to use the network for fallback communications.

The same day that I2P users began noticing the outages, the individuals in control of Kimwolf posted to their Discord channel that they had accidentally disrupted I2P after attempting to join 700,000 Kimwolf-infected bots as nodes on the network.

Although Kimwolf is known as a potent weapon for launching DDoS attacks, the outages caused this week by some portion of the botnet attempting to join I2P are what’s known as a “Sybil attack,” a threat in peer-to-peer networks where a single entity can disrupt the system by creating, controlling, and operating a large number of fake, pseudonymous identities.

Indeed, the number of Kimwolf-infected routers that tried to join I2P this past week was many times the network’s normal size. I2P’s Wikipedia page says the network consists of roughly 55,000 computers distributed throughout the world, with each participant acting as both a router (to relay traffic) and a client.

However, Lance James, founder of the New York City based cybersecurity consultancy Unit 221B and the original founder of I2P, told KrebsOnSecurity the entire I2P network

now consists of between 15,000 and 20,000 devices on any given day.

Benjamin Brundage is founder of Synthient , a startup that tracks proxy services and was the first to document Kimwolf's unique spreading techniques . Brundage said the Kimwolf operator(s) have been trying to build a command and control network that can't easily be taken down by security companies and network operators that are working together to combat the spread of the botnet.

Brundage said the people in control of Kimwolf have been experimenting with using I2P and a similar anonymity network — Tor — as a backup command and control network, although there have been no reports of widespread disruptions in the Tor network recently.

"I don't think their goal is to take I2P down," he said. "It's more they're looking for an alternative to keep the botnet stable in the face of takedown attempts."

The Kimwolf botnet created challenges for Cloudflare late last year when it began instructing millions of infected devices to use Cloudflare's domain name system (DNS) settings, causing control domains associated with Kimwolf to repeatedly usurp Amazon , Apple , Google and Microsoft in Cloudflare's public ranking of the most frequently requested websites.

James said the I2P network is still operating at about half of its normal capacity, and that a new release is rolling out which should bring some stability improvements over the next week for users.

Meanwhile, Brundage said the good news is Kimwolf's overlords appear to have quite recently alienated some of their more competent developers and operators, leading to a rookie mistake this past week that caused the botnet's overall numbers to drop by more than 600,000 infected systems.

"It seems like they're just testing stuff, like running experiments in production," he said. "But the botnet's numbers are dropping significantly now, and they don't seem to know what they're doing."

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FEATURES

NYT Connections Sports Edition today: Hints and answers for March 28, 2026

Mashable Tech

Today's Connections: Sports Edition is for people who live in Michigan.

As we've shared in previous hints stories, this is a version of the popular New York Times word game that seeks to test the knowledge of sports fans.

Like the original Connections, the game is all about finding the "common threads between words." And just like Wordle, Connections resets after midnight and each new set of words gets trickier and trickier — so we've served up some hints and tips to get you over the hurdle.

If you just want to be told today's puzzle, you can jump to the end of this article for the latest Connections solution. But if you'd rather solve it yourself, keep reading for some clues, tips, and strategies to assist you.

What is Connections: Sports Edition?

The NYT's latest daily word game has launched in association with The Athletic, the New York Times property that provides the publication's sports coverage. Connections can be played on both web browsers and mobile devices and require players to group four words that share something in common.

Each puzzle features 16 words and each grouping of words is split into four categories. These sets could comprise of anything from book titles, software, country names, etc. Even though multiple words will seem like they fit together, there's only one correct answer.

If a player gets all four words in a set correct, those words are removed from the board. Guess wrong and it counts as a mistake — players get up to four mistakes until the game ends.

Players can also rearrange and shuffle the board to make spotting connections easier. Additionally, each group is color-coded with yellow being the easiest, followed by green, blue, and purple. Like Wordle, you can share the results with your friends on social media.

Here's a hint for today's Connections: Sports Edition categories

Want a hint about the categories without being told the categories? Then give these a try:

Yellow: Teams in the mitten

Green: An at-bat

Blue: Teams with a similar color

Purple: Types of cards

Here are today's Connections: Sports Edition categories

Need a little extra help? Today's connections fall into the following categories:

Yellow: Michigan Teams

Green: Outcomes in an at-bat

Blue: "Red" Teams

Purple: ____Card

Looking for Wordle today? Here's the answer to today's Wordle.

Ready for the answers? This is your last chance to turn back and solve today's puzzle before we reveal the solutions.

Drumroll, please!

The solution to today's Connections: Sports Edition #550 is...

What is the answer to Connections: Sports Edition today?

Michigan Teams - LIONS, PISTONS, SPARTANS, TIGERS

Outcomes in an at-bat - FIELDER'S CHOICE, HIT, STRIKE-OUT, WALK

"Red" Teams - RED BULLS, RED SOX, RED STORM, RED WINGS

____Card - BASEBALL, LINEUP, RED, WILD

Don't feel down if you didn't manage to guess it this time. There will be new sports Connections for you to stretch your brain with tomorrow, and we'll be back again to guide you with more helpful hints.

Are you also playing NYT Strands? See hints and answers for today's Strands.

If you're looking for more puzzles, Mashable's got games now! Check out our games hub for Mahjong, Sudoku, free crossword, and more.

Not the day you're after? Here's the solution to the latest Connections.

Additionally, each group is color-coded with yellow being the easiest, followed by green, blue, and purple.

Mashable Tech

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The Government Must Not Force Companies to Participate in AI-powered Surveillance

Corynne McSherry · EFF Deeplinks

Update:

On March 24, 2026, the Northern District of California granted Anthropic’s Motion for Preliminary Injunction, finding that the government’s actions were not designed to protect national security, but rather to punish Anthropic. “Punishing Anthropic for bringing public scrutiny to the government’s contracting position is classic illegal First Amendment retaliation.”

The rapidly escalating conflict between Anthropic and the Pentagon, which started when the company refused to let the government use its technology to spy on Americans, has now gone to court. The Department of Defense retaliated by designating the company a “supply chain risk” (SCR). Now, Anthropic is asking courts to block the designation, arguing that the First Amendment does not permit the government to coerce a private actor to rewrite its code to serve government ends.

We agree.

As EFF, the Foundation for Individual Rights and Expression, and multiple other public interest organizations explained in a brief filed in support of Anthropic’s motion, the development and operation of large language models involve multiple expressive choices protected by the First Amendment. Requiring a company to rewrite its code to remove guardrails means compelling different expression, a clear constitutional violation. Further, the public record shows that the SCR designation is intended to punish the company both for pushing back and for its CEO’s public statements explaining that AI may supercharge surveillance practices that current law has proven ill-equipped to address.

As we also explain, the company’s concerns about how the government will use its technology are well-founded. The U. S. government has a long history of illegally surveilling its citizens without adequate judicial oversight based on questionable interpretations of its Constitutional and statutory obligations. The Department of Defense acquires vast troves of personal information from commercial entities, including individuals’ physical location, social media, and web browsing data. Other government agencies continue to collect and query vast quantities of Americans’ information, including by acquiring information from third party data brokers.

A growing body of social science research illustrates the chilling effects of these pervasive activities. Fearing retribution for unpopular views, dissenters stay silent. And AI only exacerbates the problem. AI can quickly analyze the government’s massive datasets or combine that information with data scraped off the internet, purchased through the commercial data broker market, or from local police surveillance devices and use all of that data to construct

a comprehensive picture of a person’s life and infer sensitive details like their religious beliefs, medical conditions, political opinions, or even sex partners. For example, an agency could use AI to infer an individual’s association with a particular mosque based on data showing that they visited its website, followed its social media accounts, and were located near the mosque during religious services. AI can also deanonymize online speech by using public information to unmask anonymous users.

It is easy to conceive how an agency, a government employee with improper intent, or a malicious hacker could exploit these capabilities to monitor public discourse, preemptively squelch dissent, or persecute people from marginalized communities. Against this background and absent meaningful changes to the governing national security laws and judicial oversight structure, it is entirely reasonable for Anthropic—or any other company—to insist on its own guardrails.

Without action from Congress, the task of protecting your privacy has fallen in large part to Big Tech—something no one wants, including Big Tech. But if Congress won’t do it, companies like Anthropic must be allowed to step in, without facing retribution.

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standard-article(title: [Sony headphones and earbuds are majorly marked down during Amazons Big Spring sale], author: [Mashable Tech], source-name: [Mashable Tech], images: (), paragraphs: ([The star of headphone deals during Amazon's Big Spring Sale is Sony. All the best models of Sony headphones are on sale, making for major savings. Even Sony's latest flagship headphones, the Sony WH-1000XM6 headphones, are down to their lowest price ever.], [If you're after a pair of Sony headphones, we've rounded up all the best deals on the brand's headphones and earbuds.], [Best Sony deal], [\$459.99 Save \$61.99], [Why we like it], [The Sony WH-1000XM6 aren't even a year old and are still the latest headphones in Sony's flagship lineup. We've tracked the headphones price through last year's Prime Day, waiting for a noteworthy price, and finally, we have one.], [Now, you can get the Sony WH-1000XM6 headphones for \$398. According to Camelcamelcamel , that brings them back down to their all-time low that we first spotted during Black Friday 2025.], [Now, during Amazon's Big Spring Sale, you can find the headphones for 13% off and save on stellar audio in a pair of headphones designed for a true audiophile.], [Sony headphones deals], [Sony WH-CH520 headphones — \$42.95 \$69.99 (save \$27.04)], [Sony WH-CH720N headphones — \$94.95 \$179.99 (save \$85.04)], [Sony ULT headphones — \$148 \$249.99 (save \$101.99)], [Sony WH-1000XM5 headphones — \$298 \$399.99 (save \$101.99)], [Sony earbuds deals], [Sony WF-C510 earbuds — \$48 \$69.99 (save \$21.99)], [Sony WF-C710N earbuds — \$88 \$129.99 (save \$41.99)], [Sony WF-1000XM6 earbuds — \$298 \$329.99 (save \$31.99)],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 332, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

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The New Yorker, The New Yorker: The mega-popular K-pop stars have been on hiatus for nearly four years. Their new album, "Arirang," tests the group's staying power in the global cultural marketplace.

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Juan Sebastián Urrego Escobar, Serverless Blog: Part 4 of 5 with our series and its time to start implementing our architecture in code and configuration using some appropriate design patterns and following a Function as a Microservice style.

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Eric Wyne, Serverless Blog: When the California Camp Fire displaced thousands of people from their homes, I built a simple serverless Twitter bot to help people get placed in temporary housing!

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Eric Schmitt and Helene Cooper, NYT Top Stories: Marines training in Okinawa, Japan, last year. Marines from the 31st Marine Expeditionary Unit have been sent to the Middle East, though it is unclear what they will be used for.

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Ananya Bhattacharya, Rest of World: The biggest obstacle to electric-vehicle charging infrastructure is turning out to be the neighbors. Communities across dozens of countries are fighting EV charging station installations, citing fire hazards, ugly design,...

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BBC News, BBC News: With one game to go until Thomas Tuchel picks his England World Cup squad, BBC Sport reporters choose their starting XIs for the summer. Who would you pick?

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Stefanie Monge, Serverless Blog: The official OpenWhisk plugin for Serverless now includes support for Cloudant DB and IBM Message Hub events, exporting Web Actions and more.

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